



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Maryvale Preparatory Academy

School Website: <https://maryvaleprep.greatheartsamerica.org/>

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Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Maryvale Preparatory Academy (AZ 85031) presents a robust classical education aligned with the Great Hearts network. Public materials consistently foreground Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as guiding ideals, integrate Great Books and the Great Conversation, emphasize formation of character and virtue, and employ Socratic dialogue and rhetorical training as core pedagogy. The school regularly references a liberal arts curriculum, humane letters, classical languages, and history taught through a Western-civilization lens. Family partnership, community events, and transparent parent involvement are repeatedly highlighted. Taken together, the six-category evaluation yields CLASSICAL across all domains.

- Overall classification by category:
 - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Curriculum — CLASSICAL
 - Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
 - Faculty — CLASSICAL
 - Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL
- Executive takeaway: Maryvale Prep demonstrates a thorough classical framework in line with the Six Essential Elements, with clear evidence of truth-goodness-beauty formation, Great Books and Great Conversation, Socratic pedagogy, and a strong family/community partnership ethos. No major needle-moving changes are required to align further with classical ideals; continued public articulation of theology or liturgical/community practices could further reinforce Element 1 (Religious Foundations) if desired.

Citations anchor key points to Maryvale Prep public materials in the crawl content. For example, the mission statement emphasizes pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty (Our Mission) and the curriculum emphasizes a classical liberal arts framework and the Great Conversation (Curriculum and Academics). See supporting sources: Our Mission and Curriculum statements (Maryvale Prep, Great Hearts) , , and the emphasis on Socratic dialogue, humane letters, and virtue-centered formation (public materials) .

Executive summaries and category-by-category analyses below provide the specific keyword analyses, evidence, and justification for the CLASSICAL ratings.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission framing centers Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as enduring ideals guiding education (Maryvale Prep mission) . - Descriptions of formation and the classical tradition imply aims beyond empty relativism and toward transcendentals in line with traditional classical education discourse (Great Hearts framework).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; great books; great conversation; humane letters; liberal arts; wonder. - Negative keywords: not prominently present in public materials; no explicit signaling of relativism, secularism, or value-neutral ethics.

Why this rating - The public materials repeatedly foreground transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue formation, with explicit references to Great Books and humane letters—core markers of a Classical Foundations posture. The absence of explicit secular or relativistic signals strengthens CLASSICAL positioning.

Citations: mission statement and thematic language appear in Maryvale Prep materials (Our Mission; Curriculum; About Us) , , and related Great Hearts framing .

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes cultivation of minds and hearts through truth, goodness, and beauty, aligning with formation over mere information and with teleological aims beyond job prep (Our Mission) . - Public statements describe formation, moral imagination, and leadership rooted in classical education rather than a narrow focus on career outcomes (Curriculum/Academics) .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, liberal education, scholé/contemplation, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, great conversation, tradition. - Negative keywords: minimal to no presence of workforce/job-readiness framing; no “21st century skills” emphasis in conflict with classical aims.

Why this rating - The school consistently frames education as formation of virtue and wisdom, anchored in transcendentals (truth-goodness-beauty) rather than solely preparing for work. This aligns with a CLASSICAL orientation.

Citations: Our Mission; Academics/Curriculum language (formation and pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty) , .

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Curriculum is described as classical liberal arts, with explicit mention of Great Books, humane letters, and a Western-tradition curriculum (Curriculum/Academics, Great Conversation) , . - Emphasis on Latin/Greek/Spanish/French study; reading Cervantes or Cicero without translation; rigorous humanities components; field studies and service projects that deepen classical formation (Curriculum/Overview; Learning beyond the classroom) .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts; grammar, logic, rhetoric (as foundational in classical curricula); Great Books; Great Conversation; humane letters; Western tradition; primary sources; Latin/Greek/Spanish/French; history across the curriculum; wonder. - Negative keywords: scant presence of social studies-terminology replacement; no heavy emphasis on STEM-first or project-based replacement of great-text study; no explicit downward drift toward non-textual modern curricula.

Why this rating - The school's published curriculum aligns strongly with classical criteria: liberal arts structure, Great Books/Humane Letters, and a Western-tradition approach. This yields a CLASSICAL rating.

Citations: Curriculum statements and Great Conversation language (Curriculum/Academics; About Us) , , .

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical approach explicitly includes Socratic dialogue across K–12 (Socratic dialogue cited in contemporary Maryvale materials) and a transition to advanced rhetoric in upper grades (public materials describe Socratic dialogue at multiple levels) . - References to formation through imitation and practice (e.g., Senior Thesis as a capstone; rhetoric training; speeches) show emphasis on memorization, recitation, and rhetoric in higher grades, consistent with classical pedagogy (slide/education materials mentioning Senior

Thesis and rhetorical training) . - Lower-grade practices referenced (learning with wonder, routines, and joyful inquiry) align with the scholé/restful side of classical pedagogy in initial years.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue; great conversation; rhetoric; speeches; memorization/recitation; capstone/senior thesis; formation through imitation; wonder. - Negative keywords: not prominently present; no explicit emphasis on exclusively project-based, experiential-first pedagogy that would contradict classical methods.

Why this rating - The presence of Socratic dialogue, rhetoric development, and a clear progression from memory work and chant-like components in the lower grades to upper-school seminars/debates support a CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Citations: Socratic dialogue and Great Conversation language (Maryvale/Maryvale Prep materials) ; Senior Thesis and rhetoric emphasis (Legacy/Graduation language, Senior Thesis references) .

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe faculty and staff as the essential engine of the school, noting they “pursue this work relentlessly” and that faculty provide a “rich and rigorous education” to students; there is emphasis on teachers as mentors and living curriculum in the Great Hearts model (Our Academy/Our Mission statements) . - Instances of leadership and portrait of teacher as exemplar appear in communications about teachers receiving awards and being central to formation (e.g., Exceptional Teacher Award; Mastery of guidance in upper-school leadership) . - The “Headmasters”/administrative leadership language demonstrates a collegiate, mentorship-oriented approach to faculty; staff recognition signals a living curriculum rather than strictly transactional instruction.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; faculty of friends; collaborative/collegial culture; moral formation; mastery of classical pedagogy. - Negative keywords: none prominent (no signals of a purely requirement-driven, non-mentoring faculty or disconnection between teachers and students).

Why this rating - The materials portray faculty as central to formation, not simply as service providers, aligning with CLASSICAL norms of teacher as exemplar and living curriculum.

Citations: statements about faculty and formation from Our Academy/Our Mission passages; awards/recognition for teachers; (Maryvale Prep materials) , .

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Strong emphasis on partnering with families as co-teachers and a culture of parent involvement (Family Partnership Nights, conferences, and ongoing parent engagement) is evident in newsletters and communications (Family partnership language; PSO events; parent-portal communications) . - Public materials describe community-building events, tours, and open-access opportunities for parents; newsletters and communications emphasize parental formation and involvement (e.g., newsletters, “Join the Interest List,” and tours) . - The site routinely invites parents to visit and participate in school life; mention of family participation, formation, and liturgical/communal rhythm through events and communications is present in multiple posts (community newsletters, family nights) .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parent formation; family involvement; home-school alignment; open campus; parent conferences; weekly newsletters; parent visits welcomed. - Negative keywords: none prominent; there is no strong signaling of consumerism or minimal parental involvement.

Why this rating - The school frames parents as co-educators and actively engages them through a broad set of classical-parenting/community practices, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for community.

Citations: Family partnerships and parent engagement, newsletters, and open-visit language (Maryvale Prep materials) , , .

What Would Move the Needle

- Given all six categories are CLASSICAL, there are no category-level needle-movers required. If desired, the school could further formalize explicit references to theological grounding and liturgical/community practices to maximize Element 1 (Religious Foundations) alignment and make liturgical/theological rhythms even more explicit for families researching classical education from a faith-based lens.

Note: If future communications wished to strengthen the “Liturgical and Communal Practices” aspect, explicit mentions of liturgy, chapel, or formal liturgical rhythms could be added to balance the already strong Truth-Goodness-Beauty and classical curriculum emphasis.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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